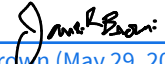




**TO:** J. Russell Peterson, Associate Professor of Practice (Clinical Associate Professor)

**FROM:** James R. Brown, Professor and Department Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

**SUBJECT:** Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

  
Jamie Brown (May 29, 2025 23:54 CDT)

This letter serves as your performance review for the period January 1, 2024 through December 31, 2024. My evaluation is based on the information submitted through Faculty 180, which includes documentation of your teaching performance, research productivity, and service activities.

Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of excellence;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of effective performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of effective performance as reflected by substantive indicators of needs improvement performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of excellent, effective, and needs improvement performance as reflected by substantive indicators of unsatisfactory performance.

#### **Teaching:**

You taught 11 sections across six different courses, reaching over 1,100 students through a mix of in-person and online formats. Your instructor effectiveness scores ranged as high as 5.0/5.0, with an overall average of 4.54/5.0. In addition to your core teaching, you led supplemental programs such as the AmplifyU Finance Seminars for student-athletes and the ARGUS Enterprise Certification Program for Master of Real Estate students. You supervised 1 Ph.D. and 21 graduate students—many outside Mays—which highlights your cross-campus engagement and mentorship. You also taught and oversaw internships and experiential learning programs, further enriching student opportunities.

Your formal teaching assignments included FINC 210 (2 sections), FINC 371 (4 sections), FINC 475 (2 sections) and FINC 670. Your comments were generally positive, with many students indicating that you are an engaging, caring, and knowledgeable professor who fosters a positive learning environment and encourages student success. Concerns centered on exam weight, feedback accessibility, and occasional lack of focus in lectures.

#### **Most Positive Comments**

- Dr. Peterson is the best professor/teacher I have ever had in all my years of school...he actually enjoys getting to know his students.
- Professor Peterson is one of my favorite professors I have learned from in Mays. I love that he is his authentic self in class and makes lectures engaging.
- Russ is one of the kindest professors that I have had at Mays. I enjoyed showing up to class every day to learn from someone who truly cares.

#### **Most Critical Comments**

- The course is way too heavily weighted toward exams—85% of your grade—and the exams have 50-60 questions, which is excessive.
- This professor was not a good communicator. I have sent several emails that have received no response, and when I went to visit office hours, the professor was not there and there was no prior notification of this.

*Department Average (Effective Course/Effective Instructor): 4.40/4.44*

**Evaluation Average (Effective Course/Effective Instructor): 4.42/4.57**

**Overall Evaluation: Excellent**

**Service:**

In 2024, you served as Director of Undergraduate Real Estate Programs and Interim Director of the Master of Real Estate program. You founded and advised the Aggie Real Estate Club, which grew to 213 members with over 450 students on its communication list. You also served on numerous college-level committees, including curriculum redesign and undergraduate/graduate curriculum. Your student mentoring extended beyond Mays through supervision of interdisciplinary graduate and doctoral students.

We appreciate your continued service as Director of Undergraduate Real Estate, particularly your work in launching and advising the Aggie Real Estate Club, which has quickly become one of our most active student organizations. At the same time, we are entering a period of review regarding the structure and responsibilities of all 'Director of Undergraduate...' leadership roles. As such, we are reappointing you to this position for one additional year, with the understanding that we will reassess the need for and scope of the role at the end of the term.

As we move forward, it is essential that this position take on a more proactive and visible role in shaping the undergraduate curriculum and coordinating efforts across the undergraduate real estate experience. We also ask that you engage more directly in leadership and planning for the undergraduate club's programming to ensure alignment with broader departmental goals. We are hopeful that with focused attention in these areas, we can continue to build on recent momentum and strengthen the undergraduate experience for our students.

**Overall Evaluation: Effective**

**Research and Scholarly Leadership:**

The research expectations for Clinical faculty members vary based on individual preferences and departmental needs. In addition to teaching responsibilities, Clinical faculty are expected to engage in a combination of service and research activities. A Clinical faculty who actively engages in research would be expected to have a lower level of service activity, and *vice versa*.

**Promotion, Tenure, and Reappointment**

You currently hold the rank of Associate Professor of Practice (Clinical Associate Professor), which you have held since September 2021. We are aware you will be seeking promotion to Clinical Professor for the coming term.

Mays' promotion guidelines indicate that Associate Professors of Practice (Clinical Associate Professors) typically serve at least five years in rank before seeking promotion, but that early promotion can be sought. Promotion to Professor of Practice (Clinical Professor) has the following minimum requirements:

- Pattern over time of excellence in teaching
- Pattern over time of effective performance in service and/or research and publication
- Potential for continued excellence in teaching and effective performance in service and/or research and publication
- Professional conduct conducive to a collegial work environment and standards of professional integrity that will advance the interests of Mays Business School and Texas A&M University

I truly appreciate all your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and to Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

Please acknowledge your receipt of this evaluation by signing below and returning a copy to me. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.

Signed 

Date 05/30/2025

# Peterson, Russ

Final Audit Report

2025-05-30

|                              |                                              |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Created:                     | 2025-05-29 (Central Daylight Time)           |
| By:                          | Lauren Gray (laurenggray@tamu.edu)           |
| Status:                      | Signed                                       |
| Transaction ID:              | CBJCHBCAABAA3Qr8g0dhlb4_mLmi22TI3xEvYfJHwyUE |
| Documents:                   | Peterson, Russ.docx (3 pages)                |
| Number of Documents:         | 1                                            |
| Document page count:         | 3                                            |
| Number of supporting files:  | 0                                            |
| Supporting files page count: | 0                                            |

## "Peterson, Russ" History

-  Document created by Lauren Gray (laurenggray@tamu.edu)  
2025-05-29 - 4:46:43 PM CDT
-  Document emailed to Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu) for signature  
2025-05-29 - 4:47:27 PM CDT
-  Email viewed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)  
2025-05-29 - 11:53:27 PM CDT
-  Agreement viewed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)  
2025-05-29 - 11:53:28 PM CDT
-  Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu) authenticated with Adobe Acrobat Sign.  
2025-05-29 - 11:54:18 PM CDT
-  Document e-signed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)  
Signature Date: 2025-05-29 - 11:54:18 PM CDT - Time Source: server
-  Document emailed to John Peterson (jrpeter@tamu.edu) for signature  
2025-05-29 - 11:54:20 PM CDT
-  Email viewed by John Peterson (jrpeter@tamu.edu)  
2025-05-30 - 12:41:07 PM CDT
-  Agreement viewed by John Peterson (jrpeter@tamu.edu)  
2025-05-30 - 12:41:37 PM CDT

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2025-05-30 - 1:01:44 PM CDT

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